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INDIA IS UNDERGOING A quiet but far-reaching transformation in how wealth is made and by whom. The country is on track to mint its youngest generation of billionaires, many still in their twenties, marking a decisive break from how Indian wealth has traditionally been built. The contrast is clear. The median age of an Indian billionaire is around 67, while for self-made billionaires, it is early 30s. Further down the pipeline, an even younger set of soon-to-be billionaires is emerging, poised to reshape the country's wealth demographics altogether.

Zepto's co-founders, Aadit Palicha and Kaivalya Vohra, illustrate this shift best. At 23, they already rank among India's youngest rupee-billionaires, with net worths of ₹5,380 crore and ₹4,480 crore respectively, according to the M3M Hurun India Rich List 2025, translating into roughly \$650 million and \$540 million, respectively.

With Zepto's valuation now past \$3.6 billion ahead of its IPO, a strong listing could push their individual holdings beyond the \$1 billion mark, making them India's youngest-ever dollar billionaires.

As per the Hurun Rich List 2025, India added 57 new billionaires over the year, and more than half were self-made. That's still some way behind China (90% self-made) and the



WAITING IN THE WINGS

BEYOND MUMBAI, BEYOND TECH: A NEW CLASS OF YOUNG, SELF-MADE ENTREPRENEURS IS CLOSING IN ON BILLIONAIRE STATUS AND CHANGING WHAT WEALTH CREATION IN INDIA LOOKS LIKE

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